

The OPERATE Framework™

Onboarding & Delivery Checklist

Set up and deliver any assignment to a high standard — repeatably.

OPERATE is a seven-element delivery methodology: Observe & Orient, Plan & Prioritise, Engage Stakeholders, Review & Remediate, Advise & Act, Transfer & Embed, Evaluate & Evolve. Part 1 below is your first-week orientation (the “O”). Part 2 is the recurring weekly delivery loop (P-E-R-A-T-E) you run every week until the assignment is complete.

Contract / Assignment Details

Your Name	
Client / Assignment	
Start Date	
End Date (optional)	

Part 1: ‘O’ for Observe & Orient — Your First Week Mission

A flawless setup prevents future friction. Earn the right to act by understanding the assignment before you dive in. Complete this in your first week.

Day 1: Technology & Access Lockdown

Take ownership and understand what you need in order to deliver — and to get paid.

Your Setup

- ☐ Equipment sorted: working laptop/device — test everything thoroughly
- ☐ Connectivity check: Wi-Fi, VPN and all necessary networks
- ☐ Platform access: Slack, Teams, Jira, shared drives, email
- ☐ Physical access: building pass, desk, meeting rooms (if applicable)
- ☐ Remote/hybrid setup (if applicable): master core comms and virtual meeting etiquette

Getting Paid Essentials

- ☐ Timesheet process: who signs it, and the cut-off dates/times
- ☐ Payment cycle: the exact process and payment dates
- ☐ Backup signatory: who deputises for your timesheet signatory
- ☐ Invoice process: end-to-end submission and payment (if applicable)

Day 1 Notes & Observations

Days 2-5: People, Processes & Culture

Be a friendly detective — connect and understand.

People (Your Stakeholder Map)

- ☐ Identify all stakeholders: everyone who influences your success
- ☐ Schedule intro meetings: brief chats with each key person (15–30 mins)
- ☐ Know your team: immediate members and their roles
- ☐ Find your champions: the go-to people and influencers
- ☐ Include everyone: security, cleaning and admin staff are stakeholders too
- ☐ Manager’s communication style: preferences and expectations

Processes (How Things Really Get Done)

- ☐ Internal workflows: the key processes for deliverables
- ☐ Communication rhythms: primary channels and meeting cadences
- ☐ Unspoken rules: the real culture (is “camera optional” really optional?)
- ☐ Escalation paths: how to raise issues or get help

Culture & Environment

- ☐ Hybrid reality check: office expectations, core hours, flexibility
- ☐ Team norms: working patterns and expectations
- ☐ Company culture: values in action vs stated values
- ☐ Observe before contributing: watch one full team meeting before speaking much
- ☐ Success metrics: what “good” looks like in this environment

What have you taken away from your observations? What will you do differently to deliver on this assignment?

End of Week 1: Governance & Clarity

Define your contribution — be clear about deliverables.

Governance (Rules of Engagement)

- ☐ Essential meetings: which you must attend
- ☐ Reporting cadence: propose and agree a proactive reporting schedule
- ☐ Org structure: high-level team/company structure
- ☐ Decision making: who has authority for what
- ☐ Escalation process: when and how to escalate

Deliverables & Expectations

- ☐ Clarify your role: what does “job well done” look like for month one?
- ☐ Success metrics: get specific about how success is measured
- ☐ Manager check-in: schedule a vital meeting to confirm understanding
- ☐ Potential pitfalls: spot the risks and challenges early

Manager Check-in Agenda (schedule this proactively)

- ☐ Confirm understanding of initial tasks and priorities
- ☐ Discuss how progress will be reviewed and reported
- ☐ Clarify what “good” looks like and the success metrics
- ☐ Ask all your burning questions — seriously, all of them
- ☐ Agree communication frequency and methods

My Deliverables & Success Metrics

Deliverable	Success Metric	Review Date

Deliverable	Success Metric	Review Date

Week 1 Reflection

My biggest win this week:

My biggest surprise:

What I would do differently:

Quick wins I've identified:

Potential challenges to watch:

Orientation Gate-Check

Confirm all of these before moving to the weekly delivery loop. Don't start Week 2 until you can tick every box.

Technology & Access

- ☐ All systems work and I have documented access details
- ☐ I know who to contact for IT support
- ☐ Payment/timesheet process is crystal clear

People & Relationships

- ☐ I've met (or scheduled meetings with) all key stakeholders and have their contacts
- ☐ I understand everyone's role and communication preferences
- ☐ I have at least one "go-to" person for questions

Processes & Culture

- ☐ I understand how work gets done here
- ☐ I know the unspoken rules and cultural norms
- ☐ I have all necessary process documentation

Governance & Clarity

- ☐ My role and deliverables are clearly defined
- ☐ I have regular check-in meetings scheduled
- ☐ I know who makes decisions and approves my work

Ready for the Delivery Loop

- ☐ I can confidently start contributing value
- ☐ I have a plan for my first month
- ☐ I feel prepared to succeed in this environment

You've completed Stage 'O' Observe & Orient and are ready for the weekly cycle.

Part 2: The P-E-R-A-T-E Weekly Cycle

Your recurring weekly rhythm for delivering successfully. Fill this out every Monday morning before you start work. Steps marked “Private” are for your own delivery management, not shared with the client.

Four blank weekly copies follow. Copy the pages for any additional weeks.

Weekly Cycle — Week 1

Week Commencing	
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PLAN & PRIORITISE (P)

What are the 1–3 key outcomes I will deliver this week? Which prioritisation call did I make (value/effort, MoSCoW), and how are they blocked into my calendar?

ENGAGE STAKEHOLDERS (E)

Who do I need to update or bring on side this week? What is my proactive reporting action and when will I do it (e.g. Friday summary, weekly sync)? Any relationship or difficult conversation to handle early?

REVIEW & REMEDIATE (R) — Private

Honest status — Green / Amber / Red? Any new risks or issues to log in the Risk & Issue Tracker? If anything has slipped, what is my course-correction?

ADVISE & ACT (A) — Private

What one recommendation or quick win can I offer the client this week beyond the brief? Log it in the Value Tracker.

TRANSFER & EMBED (T) — Private

What did I do this week that should be captured in the handover pack rather than left in my head? Is anything becoming a single point of failure on me?

EVALUATE & EVOLVE (E) — Private

*Is this project on track overall? What did I learn this week that should change how I work next week?
Is there an opportunity to propose a next phase or follow-on work?*

Weekly Cycle — Week 2

Week Commencing	
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PLAN & PRIORITISE (P)

What are the 1–3 key outcomes I will deliver this week? Which prioritisation call did I make (value/effort, MoSCoW), and how are they blocked into my calendar?

ENGAGE STAKEHOLDERS (E)

Who do I need to update or bring on side this week? What is my proactive reporting action and when will I do it (e.g. Friday summary, weekly sync)? Any relationship or difficult conversation to handle early?

REVIEW & REMEDIATE (R) — Private

Honest status — Green / Amber / Red? Any new risks or issues to log in the Risk & Issue Tracker? If anything has slipped, what is my course-correction?

ADVISE & ACT (A) — Private

What one recommendation or quick win can I offer the client this week beyond the brief? Log it in the Value Tracker.

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EVALUATE & EVOLVE (E) — Private

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Is there an opportunity to propose a next phase or follow-on work?*

Weekly Cycle — Week 3

Week Commencing	
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PLAN & PRIORITISE (P)

What are the 1–3 key outcomes I will deliver this week? Which prioritisation call did I make (value/effort, MoSCoW), and how are they blocked into my calendar?

ENGAGE STAKEHOLDERS (E)

Who do I need to update or bring on side this week? What is my proactive reporting action and when will I do it (e.g. Friday summary, weekly sync)? Any relationship or difficult conversation to handle early?

REVIEW & REMEDIATE (R) — Private

Honest status — Green / Amber / Red? Any new risks or issues to log in the Risk & Issue Tracker? If anything has slipped, what is my course-correction?

ADVISE & ACT (A) — Private

What one recommendation or quick win can I offer the client this week beyond the brief? Log it in the Value Tracker.

TRANSFER & EMBED (T) — Private

What did I do this week that should be captured in the handover pack rather than left in my head? Is anything becoming a single point of failure on me?

EVALUATE & EVOLVE (E) — Private

*Is this project on track overall? What did I learn this week that should change how I work next week?
Is there an opportunity to propose a next phase or follow-on work?*

Weekly Cycle — Week 4

Week Commencing

PLAN & PRIORITISE (P)

What are the 1–3 key outcomes I will deliver this week? Which prioritisation call did I make (value/effort, MoSCoW), and how are they blocked into my calendar?

ENGAGE STAKEHOLDERS (E)

Who do I need to update or bring on side this week? What is my proactive reporting action and when will I do it (e.g. Friday summary, weekly sync)? Any relationship or difficult conversation to handle early?

REVIEW & REMEDIATE (R) — Private

Honest status — Green / Amber / Red? Any new risks or issues to log in the Risk & Issue Tracker? If anything has slipped, what is my course-correction?

ADVISE & ACT (A) — Private

What one recommendation or quick win can I offer the client this week beyond the brief? Log it in the Value Tracker.

TRANSFER & EMBED (T) — Private

What did I do this week that should be captured in the handover pack rather than left in my head? Is anything becoming a single point of failure on me?

EVALUATE & EVOLVE (E) — Private

*Is this project on track overall? What did I learn this week that should change how I work next week?
Is there an opportunity to propose a next phase or follow-on work?*

Delivery Trackers

Use these alongside the weekly cycle. Private — for your own delivery management.

Stakeholder Map

Supports Observe & Orient (O) and Engage Stakeholders (E).

Name	Role	Influence (H/M/L)	Comms Style	Met? / Date	Notes

Deliverables & Success-Metrics Tracker

Agreed in O, reviewed in R, measured in the final E.

Deliverable	Success Metric	Status (R/A/G)	Review Date

Risk & Issue Tracker

For Review & Remediate (R). Log risks and issues during your weekly Review step.

Risk / Issue	Status (R/A/G)	Mitigation / Action	Owner	Date

Risk / Issue	Status (R/A/G)	Mitigation / Action	Owner	Date

Value Tracker

For Advise & Act (A). Log quick wins and added value during your weekly Advise step.

Quick Win / Improvement	Value to Client	Status	Date

Handover Log (NEW)

For Transfer & Embed (T). Capture anything that should not live only in your head.

Item	What it is	Where documented	Owner after me	Status

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Quick Reference — The Seven Elements

Letter	Element	When
O	Observe & Orient	Part 1 — your first week (orientation)
P	Plan & Prioritise	Part 2 — weekly cycle
E	Engage Stakeholders	Part 2 — weekly cycle
R	Review & Remediate	Part 2 — weekly cycle
A	Advise & Act	Part 2 — weekly cycle
T	Transfer & Embed	Part 2 — weekly cycle
E	Evaluate & Evolve	Part 2 — weekly cycle

OPERATE™ and the OPERATE Framework™ are part of Master Your Career Path.